The main reasons to go with Amazon's platforms are if you:

- Are already heavily invested in AWS
- Want to integrate with your existing AWS infrastructure
- Want to integrate with other AWS services
- Have a lot of AWS experience on the team
- Want to build something extremely custom

If you have no existing baggage and just want to get up and running fast, I'd recommend Google Kubernetes Engine as a starting point. It seems to be the most mature offering, and Kubernetes started life at Google.

Serverless for Containers

Much fuss has been made about the name *serverless computing*,[30,31,32] but putting that aside, there's a growing demand for ever-more-abstracted services.

Popularized by services like Amazon's AWS Lambda,[33] Serverless Computing has become synonymous with Functions as a Service (FAAS). You supply some code to be run when a particular event occurs, and the platform takes care of how and where it's run. Although the code you supply is typically turned into containers behind the scenes, that's an implementation detail you don't need to care about. The benefit to this computing model is that you completely remove the need to provision infrastructure, and scaling happens automatically based on load.

However, a major downside is that you are limited by the languages and tooling supported by the FAAS platform.[34] If, instead of supplying raw code files, you provide your own Docker images, you get all the benefits of FAAS, but with fewer runtime limitations. Rather than being constrained by the platform, you have full control over what languages and tooling your code uses.

Sound too good to be true? Well, the future is already here—at least, a limited version of it. There are only two offerings so far, but no doubt more will gradually appear, and the services will continue to mature.

30. https://twitter.com/thepracticaldev/status/857075416217010178
31. https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=14742273
32. https://hackernoon.com/what-the-hell-does-serverless-mean-219a5f6e3c6a
33. https://aws.amazon.com/lambda
34. https://docs.aws.amazon.com/lambda/latest/dg/current-supported-versions.html